

Gigabyte GA-7NNXP Motherboard

Loaded to the boot

The GA-7NNXP is the latest AMD platform motherboard. It is based on the Nforce2 chipset.

The board layout is traditional Gigabyte—loads of colourful connectors on a bright blue PCB. The capaci-



tor layout near the CPU is good, except for one in the extreme upper left hand corner that came in the way when we were installing our bigger HSF (heat sink fan).

On the features front, the board comes with an awesome assortment of technologies. It supports dual-channel DDR 400 MHz via four colour-coded memory slots; the AGP Pro 8X slot can take all the latest graphic cards; it also has nVidia's onboard sound system, which is more powerful and feature rich than any other onboard audio solution. The board also has IDE RAID and S-ATA RAID functions, two LAN connectors—Ethernet and Gigabit LAN, the usual Dual Bios technology. One unique feature is the dual power system (DPS) via a daughter card that can be plugged into a small slot near the CPU. The DPS provides a six-phase supply to boost the voltage needs when overclocking.

Price: Rs 15,000
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We tested the GA-7NNXP with an AMD Athlon 3200+ processor, 512 MB of DDR 400 MHz Corsair memory and an ATi 9800 128 MB graphics card. This board outshone all the other AMD boards we've tested so far. There were no bottlenecks in the CPU test. The SiSoft Sandra CPU test yielded scores of 8209 and 3297 respectively for the Dhrystones and Whetstones—the best yet for any AMD platform. The memory scores were lower than those obtained on a Pentium 4 machine. In Quake 3 Arena, the scores were always above 300 fps, no matter what resolution we selected. At the highest resolution of 1,204 x 768 at 32-bit, the system returned 315 fps, indicating its superior performance.

Encoding a 50 MB video file took just 72 seconds. In the ZDbench Content Creation and Business Winstone benchmarks it scored 40.2 and 34.6 units respectively, indicating the seamless working of all the sub-systems to deliver where it counts.

At Rs 15,000, the GA-7NNXP is expensive, but considering the features it offers, and the 3 year warranty, we're drawn to the conclusion that it's the best AMD platform motherboard that money can buy.

SPECIFICATIONS

Supports AMD Athlon 3200+, dual-channel DDR 400, USB 2.0, Firewire, six-channel sound

Gigabyte GA-7NNXP Motherboard		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

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